

Mouth Ulcers - Female (Child)

Algorithm 1216 | Child (0-17 years) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- Mouth ulcer assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published when-to-get-help guidance.
- Child patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the person's exact age and sex, are they pregnant or immunocompromised, how long has the lesion been present, and is there fever, dehydration, weight loss, trauma, tobacco/betel use, medicine exposure, eye/genital lesions, or safeguarding concern?
2. [OPEN_TEXT] How large is it, and is it painful?
3. [YES_NO] Any ulcers elsewhere on the body or joint pain?
4. [CAREGIVER_OBSERVATION] What has a safe parent or caregiver observed about alertness, breathing, pain, swelling, fever, eating or drinking, sleep, play, and normal activity?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Disposition level 50

Are fluid-filled blisters on or around the lips the main concern rather than ulcers inside the mouth?

The cold-sore family is not generated. Arrange in-person clinical assessment through an approved local service.

1. Disposition level 50

Has the ulcer lasted longer than 3 weeks, is it unusually large or near the throat, is it bleeding or becoming more painful and red, or are there ulcers elsewhere on the body with joint symptoms?

NHS.UK guidance recommends arranging a primary-care review or dentist for these features - prolonged ulcers can occasionally indicate a more serious condition.

1. Disposition level 15

Is this a typical, recent mouth ulcer with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance: mouth ulcers are common and should clear up on their own within 1-2 weeks.

Advice

Routine mouth ulcer follow-up

- Book a primary-care or dental review for these features.
- Call Back If: ulcer grows or bleeds more.

Governed care for a minor mouth ulcer

- Use a soft toothbrush, cool soft foods/fluids if swallowing safely, and avoid irritating spicy, salty, acidic, or rough foods. Mouthwash, analgesic gel/spray, steroid lozenge, and salt-rinse advice require exact age, pregnancy/breastfeeding, allergy, swallowing safety, medical conditions, and current-medicine checks under the approved Qatar pathway. Do not apply aspirin to the ulcer.
- Call Back If: lasts longer than 3 weeks; becomes larger, more painful, recurrent, or associated with fever, dehydration, weight loss, eye/genital lesions, or immunocompromise.

First aid

References

- NHS.UK, "Mouth ulcers", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/mouth-ulcers/> (page last reviewed 11 March 2024)

Provenance

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